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Opening Data Export Files in Excel

iMotions saves its data exports as csv files, with data columns being separated by a comma and decimals being separated with a dot. When importing the export into your analysis software, you must specify the delimiter as well as the decimal symbol for the data to be read correctly.

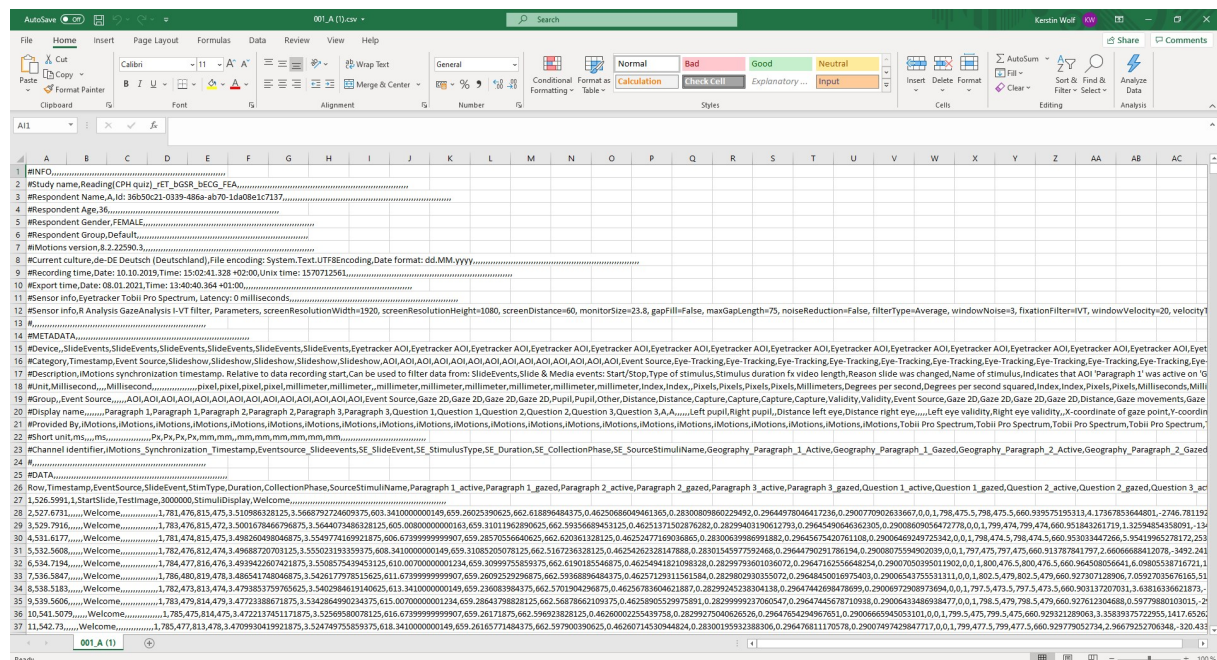
This article explains how to correctly open a file in Excel, and how to change your default settings so that you can conveniently open your files with the right settings already set. Certain regions, for example the German-speaking regions, have different default decimal separators than used internationally, which leads to Excel using "wrong" default parameters.

In this article:

- [Example: Incorrectly and correctly read csv files in Microsoft Excel](#)
- [How to specify separators when opening files in Microsoft Excel](#)
- [How to adjust regional settings \(default parameters\)](#)

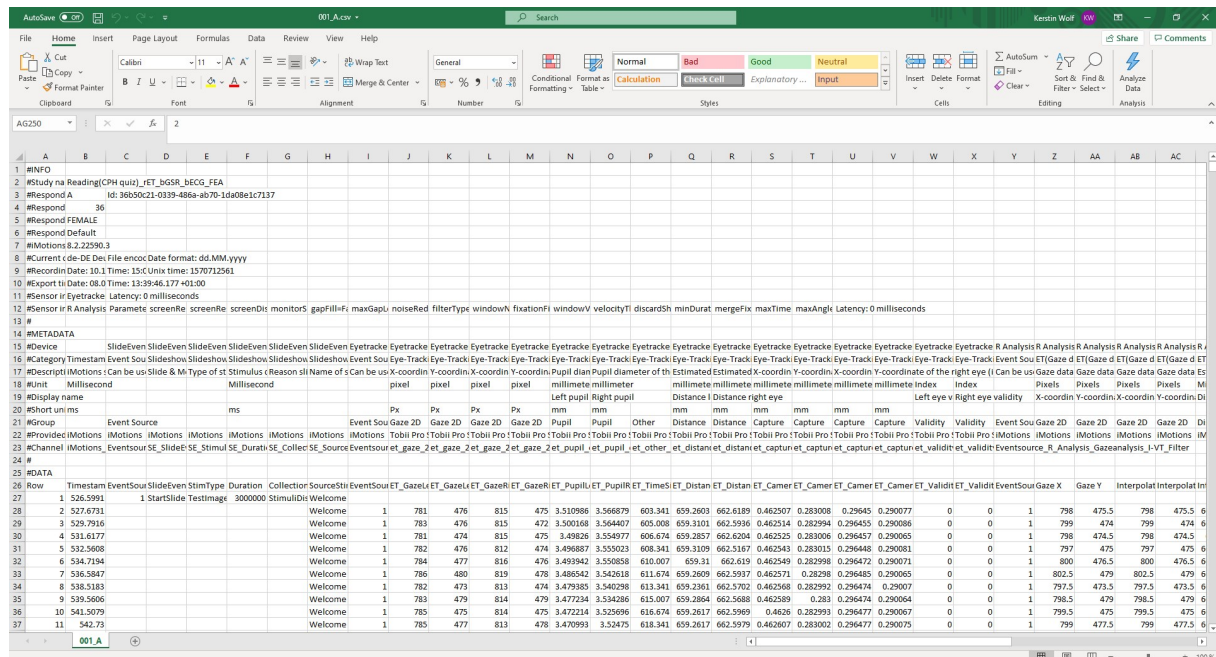
Example: Incorrectly and correctly read csv files in Microsoft Excel

If a csv was not read out correctly, it will look like this in Excel (here, Sensor Data export):



The screenshot shows a Microsoft Excel spreadsheet with a CSV file imported incorrectly. The data is garbled, with many characters appearing as question marks and the text is not aligned properly in the columns. The spreadsheet has a standard Excel interface with a ribbon at the top and a grid of cells below. The data appears to be a mix of text and numbers, but it is not readable due to the incorrect import settings.

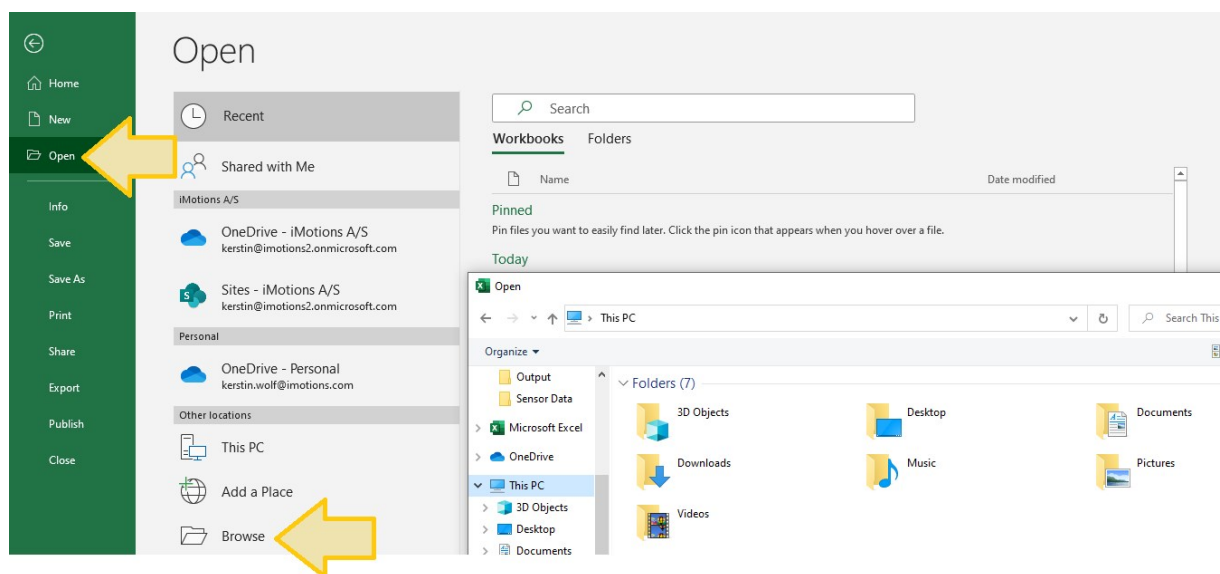
A correctly read file will show the data columns separately:



How to specify separators when opening files in Microsoft Excel

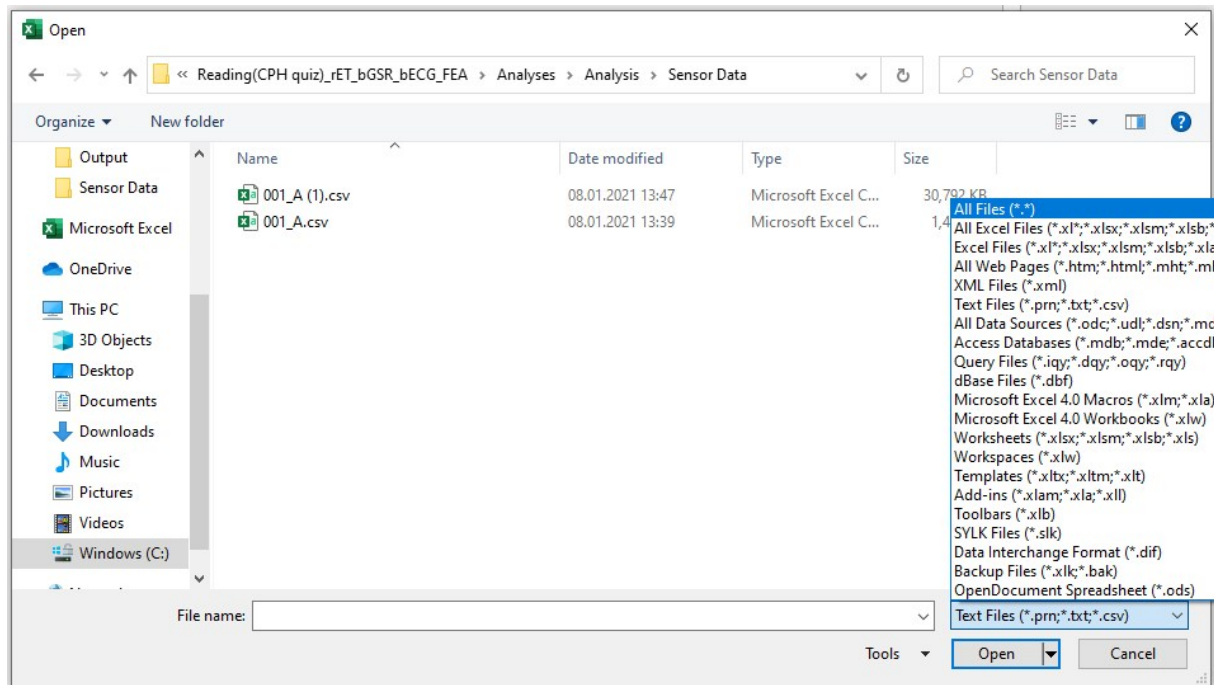
If you just open your export by double clicking the file or dropping it into Excel, it will be opened using the **default parameters**. The recommended workflow in order for your iMotions data export files to be opened properly in Excel is to:

1. Open Excel on your computer.
2. When the application opens, select “Open” in the left menu.



3. Next, select “Browse” under “Other locations”. This will allow you to select a file from your saved computer files by browsing to the folder containing the export you would like to work with.

4. When the next window opens, make sure the file type is either set to "All Files" or "Text files".



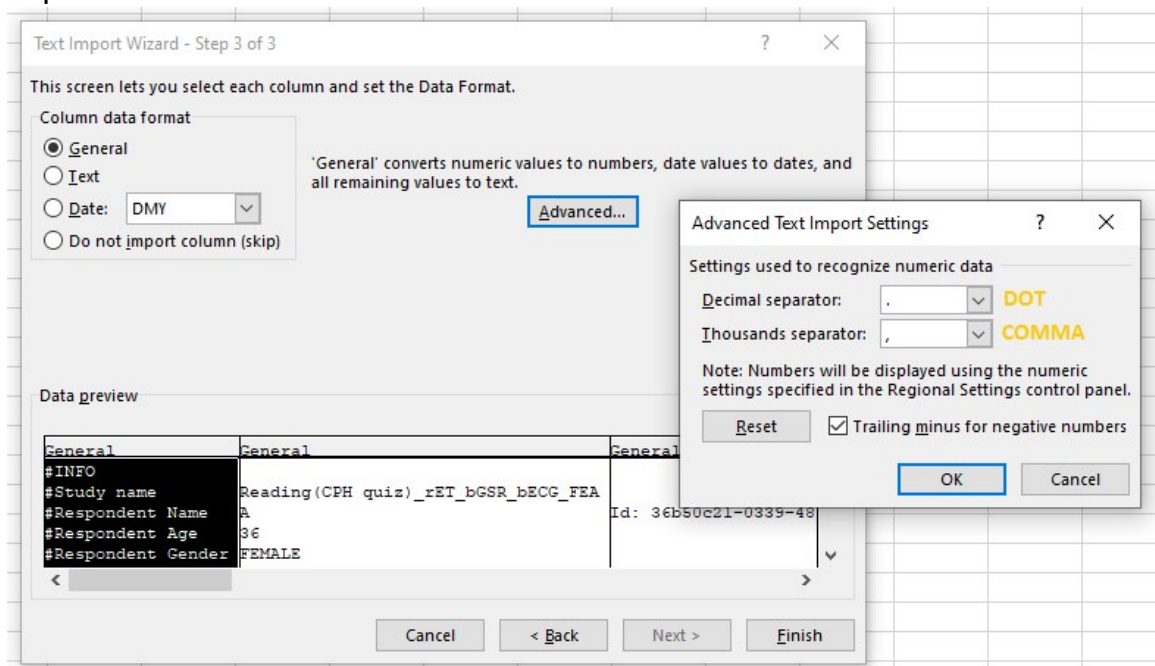
5. Now you should be able to select and open the desired file.

6. The “Text Import Wizard” window will now open. In order to correctly import the text file, certain parameters must be selected.

6.1 Select "Delimited" file type

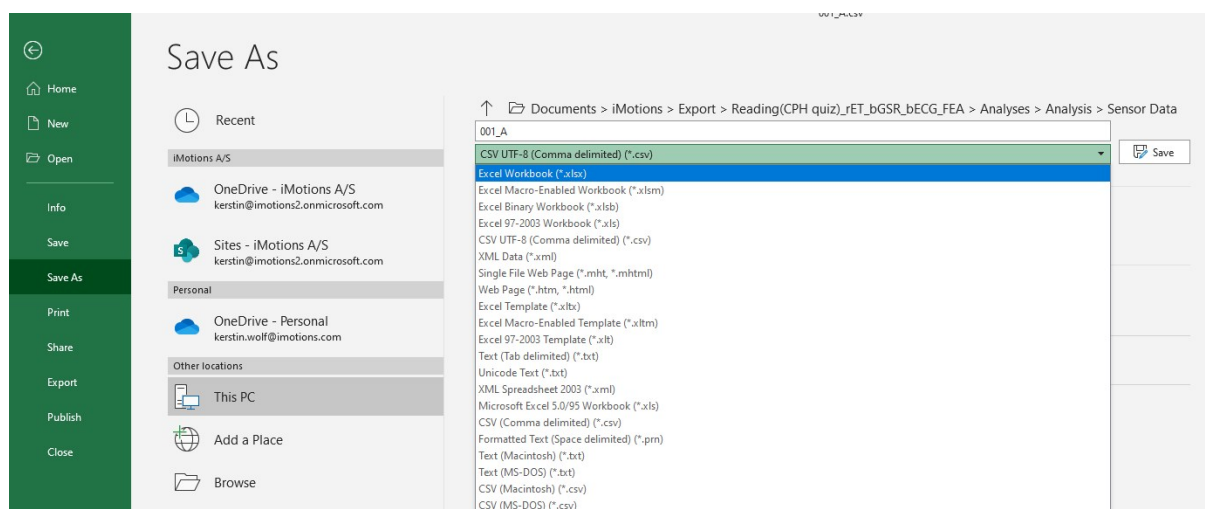
6.2 Start import at row 1

8. In step 3, make sure Excel is recognizing the decimal separator correctly. iMotions is following the international convention of separating decimals with a *dot*. However, some regions (e.g. the German-speaking regions) separate decimals by a comma. Open "Advanced" to define the decimal and thousands separator.



9. Click "Finish" to import your export into Excel

Please note: If you want your data to be properly saved as an Excel file (and not a csv file, in which you are likely to lose what edits were made to the imported data because csv files do not preserve formatting or newly opened tabs), you must choose that file type (.xls or .xlsx) when saving the file.



How to adjust regional settings (default parameters)

Instead of clicking through the import wizard every time you want to work with an export, you can also change your computer's regional settings:

1. Open the "Control Panel" on your PC
2. Click "Change date, time, or number formats"
3. Open "Additional settings"
4. Make sure that
 1. Decimal symbol is dot
 2. Digit grouping symbol is comma
 3. List separator is comma
5. Click "OK" twice (once on each pop up window)

